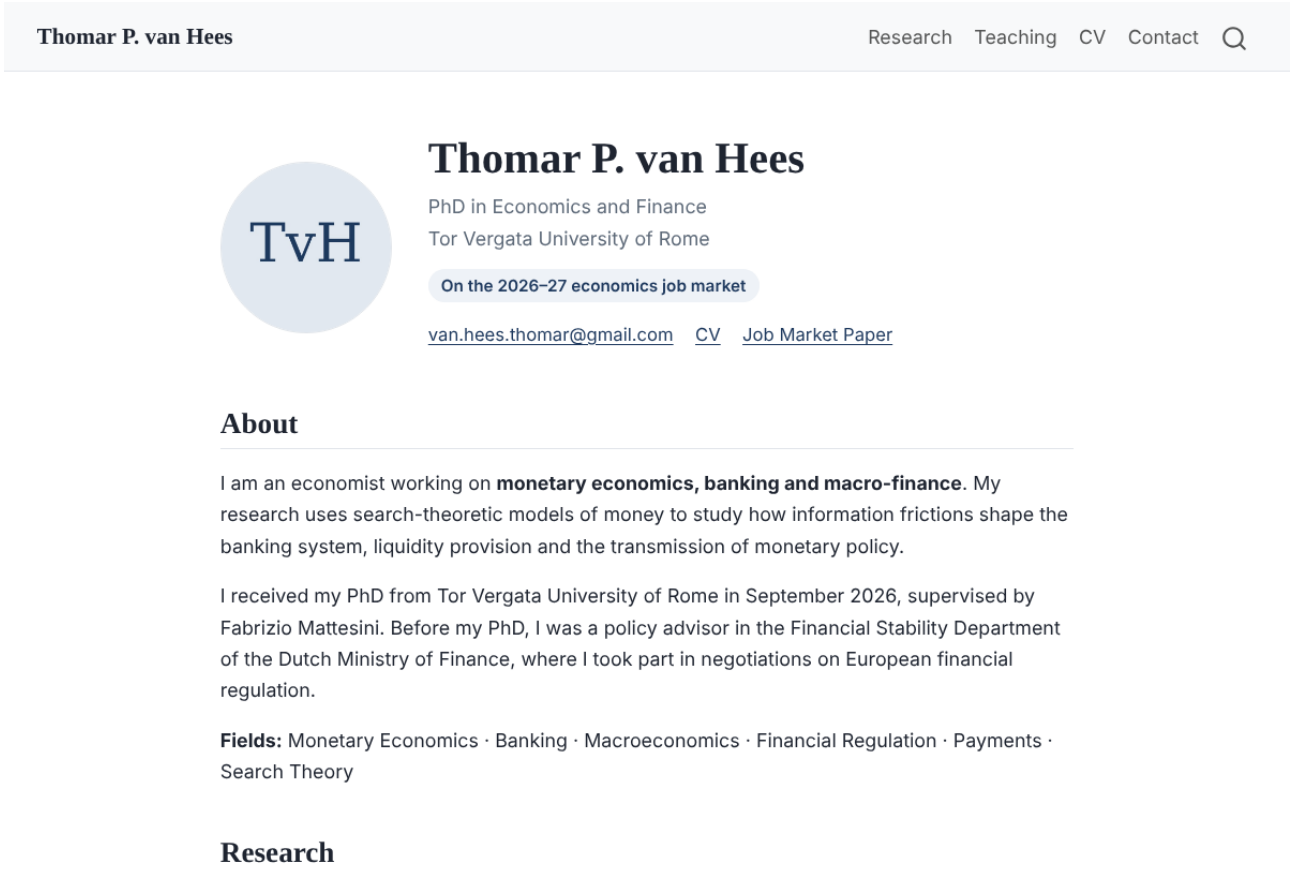
Your Job Market Website

Edit in RStudio, publish free on GitHub Pages

The site is one page, written in plain text (Markdown) in a single file, **index.qmd**. RStudio turns it into a website with one click (**Render**), and GitHub hosts it for free at **https://USERNAME.github.io**. You never need to touch HTML. The whole set-up takes about 30 minutes the first time; later updates take two minutes.



Preview of the site (the photo is a placeholder until you add your own).

1. What is in the folder

File or folder	What it is	Do you edit it?
index.qmd	All the text of the page: about, papers, teaching, references, contact	Yes, this is the main file
files/	vanHees_JMP.pdf and vanHees_CV.pdf	Replace the PDFs (keep the names)
images/profile.jpg	Your photo (now a 'TvH' placeholder)	Replace with your photo, same name
_quarto.yml	Site settings: title, menu bar, footer, your web address	Rarely
styles.css	Colours, fonts and spacing	Only to change the look
vanhees-website.Rproj	The RStudio project. Double-click to open everything	No
docs/	The finished website that RStudio builds. This is what goes online	Never by hand; Render rebuilds it

2. One-time installation

1. Install **R** from cran.r-project.org (if you do not have it).
2. Install or update **RStudio Desktop** from posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop. Recent versions include **Quarto**, the tool that builds the site, so nothing else is needed.
3. Create a free account at **github.com**. Your username becomes your web address: https://USERNAME.github.io (e.g. thomarvanhees.github.io).
4. Install **GitHub Desktop** from desktop.github.com and sign in with your GitHub account. It uploads your site with two clicks, without the command line.

3. Open and preview the site in RStudio

1. Unzip **vanhees-website.zip** somewhere permanent (e.g. Documents/vanhees-website).
2. Double-click **vanhees-website.Rproj**. RStudio opens with the project loaded.
3. In the **Files** pane, click **index.qmd** to open it.
4. Click the blue **Render** button above the editor (or press Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + K). The site appears in the Viewer pane or your browser. Alternatively use the **Build** tab > **Render Website**.
5. Each time you save and Render, the preview updates and the **docs/** folder is rebuilt.

If the Render button does not appear, type this in the RStudio **Terminal** tab instead:

```
quarto preview
```

4. Editing the content

Everything is in **index.qmd**. Each section starts with a line beginning with ##. Change the text, save, and Render.

To do this	Write this in index.qmd
Bold / italic	**bold** and *italic*
Link	[link text](https://example.com)
Bullet point	- New item (a dash and a space at the start of the line)
New section	## Section name {#anchor} (the anchor lets the menu jump there)
Line break within a paragraph	end the line with

Adding a paper. Copy a whole block from **::: paper** to the closing **:::**, paste it below, and change the title, co-authors, status and abstract:

```
::: paper
**Title of the New Paper**<br>
<span class="meta">with Co-Author · *Working paper*</span>

<details>
<summary>Abstract</summary>

Your abstract here.

</details>
:::
```

Linking a paper PDF. Put the PDF in **files/** and turn the title into a link: **[**Title**](files/paper.pdf)**.
Photo. Save a square photo as **images/profile.jpg**, replacing the placeholder.
Menu bar. The items at top right (Research, Teaching, CV, Contact) are set in **_quarto.yml** under **navbar**.
Colour. The accent colour is **--accent: #1f3a5f;** at the top of **styles.css**.

5. Publish on GitHub Pages (first time)

1. Open **_quarto.yml** and replace **USERNAME** in **site-url** with your GitHub username. Save and click **Render** once.
2. Open **GitHub Desktop**: **File > Add local repository**, choose your vanhees-website folder. It will say it is not a repository yet; click **create a repository**, then **Create repository**.
3. Click **Publish repository**. Set the name to exactly **USERNAME.github.io** and **untick** "Keep this code private". Click Publish.
4. On github.com, open the repository and go to **Settings > Pages**. Under **Build and deployment**, choose **Deploy from a branch**, branch **main**, folder **/docs**, and click **Save**.
5. Wait 1-2 minutes. Your site is live at **https://USERNAME.github.io**.

Without GitHub Desktop: create the repository USERNAME.github.io on github.com (public), click **uploading an existing file**, drag in the whole folder's contents (including docs/), commit, then do step 4.

6. Updating the site later (2 minutes)

1. Edit **index.qmd** (or replace a PDF in **files/**), save.
2. Click **Render**. **Always render before uploading**: the online site is the docs/ folder, which only changes when you render.
3. In GitHub Desktop, type a short summary (e.g. "New JMP version"), click **Commit to main**, then **Push origin**. The site updates within a minute or two.

7. The 'latest version' link for your JMP

Your paper is always available at the address below. Replace **files/vanHees_JMP.pdf** with each new version, keeping the name, then Render and push. Use this address in the \href on the JMP title page:

```
https://USERNAME.github.io/files/vanHees_JMP.pdf
```

Use the same idea for the CV: **files/vanHees_CV.pdf**.

8. Checklist before you share the link

- ■ Replace **files/vanHees_JMP.pdf** with the corrected JMP (new title page, proofreading fixes).
- ■ Replace **files/vanHees_CV.pdf** with the fixed CV (ligatures, website link, Alexandrov).
- ■ Add your photo as **images/profile.jpg**.
- ■ In index.qmd, add Andrey Alexandrov's email (marked with a comment in the References section) and double-check Paolo Varraso's address (uniroma.it vs uniroma2.it).
- ■ Replace USERNAME in **_quarto.yml**, Render, push.
- ■ Open the live site on your phone and click every link (Email, CV, Job Market Paper).

9. If something goes wrong

Problem	Fix
Site shows 404	Check Settings > Pages uses branch main and folder /docs; the repository must be public and named USERNAME.github.io; wait 2 minutes.
Changes are not online	You probably forgot to Render before committing, or forgot to Push in GitHub Desktop.
Old PDF still shows	Your browser cached it: reload with Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + R.
Render gives an error	Usually a missing ::: or an unclosed <details> in index.qmd. Undo the last change and render again; the error message names the line.
No Render button	Update RStudio, or run quarto preview in the Terminal tab.